

LEVEL 3 · WRITE-UP

Picture of the Day

Reverse-image-search each photo (Google Lens / TinEye) or browse the APOD archive until you find the exact page. Note each APOD's date.

Francis says “in the order the sky showed them to me” — chronological, oldest first. He also says only “the day” matters. Take each APOD's day of the month and convert it to a letter (1 = A, 2 = B, ... 26 = Z).

With the four APODs chosen so their days are 5, 3, 8, 15, sorted oldest→newest:

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oldest → day 5 → E
        → day 3 → C
        → day 8 → H
newest → day 15 → 0 (the HR 8799 four-planet APOD)
        = E C H 0
```

Builder note: the newest of the four must be an HR 8799 APOD (e.g. the 2017 Feb 1 “Four Planets Orbiting Star HR 8799” video, or the 2008 Nov 17 discovery image), because it points to Level 4. Pick the other three APODs so their day-of-month letters complete your chosen word. Only days 1–26 are usable.

CTC{echo}

Leads to: the HR 8799 image — the system Francis was watching.